

# Murder Mystery

*Dinner Party 2026*

---



## Dada DiCapo

---

*The Meridian Museum*

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

# INTRODUCTIONS



Dada DiCapo

---

## *Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity*

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. She is the embodiment of contemporary art.

- Went to art school with **Vincent Van Faux**. They still remember each other's worst work.
- **Elle Loominate** has secretly helped build several of Dada's installations.
- Has made commissioned work for **Tess Tament**. **Tess** still asks whether one piece is meant to make that noise.
- Performed inside a sculpture by **Al Baster**. Dada assumed the invitation to the opening covered that.

## **ACTING TIPS**

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

## **YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD**

I'm Dada DiCapo. If the room feels uncomfortable, good. I may invoice you for the feeling. Art is money. Art is life.

*Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.*

---



Dada DiCapo

---

## Behind the portrait

### Your grievance with Grant

Grant appropriated the concept for one of your unreleased performances and planned to unveil a sanitized version of it as the gala's closing spectacle, crediting himself as creative patron.

### Your other secret

You wrote and planted the ominous anonymous warning note about 'returning what was taken.' It was meant as an art-world provocation, not a literal threat.

### Conversations to start

- Enjoy watching people overreact to your warning note without admitting you wrote it.
- Find out whether Minnie Malist changed the lighting cue you designed.

*One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.*

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



# The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *Go where a thousand stories glow; this one waits behind the screen.*
- 2 *Lift your eyes to a trophy, then look where it meets the shelf.*
- 3 *A secret waits behind drapes the color of spilled wine.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

---

## Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament**

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

---

**Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir**

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions**

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

---

**Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme**

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop**

What did Grant ask you to hide?

---

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist**

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

---

**Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks**

What did you want returned or protected?

---

**Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher**

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

---

**Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote**

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.*

---



Dada DiCapo

---

### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

Yes, I wrote the warning. Returning what was taken meant my performance concept, which Grant planned to unveil with himself credited as visionary patron. It was a provocation. He turned my work into an advertisement and then complained that the artist had supplied an uncomfortable caption.

#### IF MURDERER

I wrote the warning and meant Grant to feel threatened. He had taken my unreleased performance, stripped out the difficult parts, and awarded himself the credit. He called his version accessible. Theft is quite accessible when somebody else pays for the stage.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

---

### Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

**Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme**

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

---

**Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid**

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance**

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

---

**Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

Describe your errand at the private service station.

---

**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

What physical work or problem occupied you?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic**

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

---

**Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel**

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist**

What practical museum duty were you handling?

---

**Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher**

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

---

**Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop**

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.*

---



Dada DiCapo

---

### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.

#### IF MURDERER

I rehearsed the closing reveal after Grant ordered my name removed from the program. The scene was supposed to make the donor disappear and leave an empty jacket standing under the lights. He canceled it. I intended to run it anyway. The warning was mine, and I had arranged an apparent collapse as part of the performance. I did not announce that plan to the dining room. Surprise was rather the point.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**  
**Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

---

# Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

**Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact**

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

---

**Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist**

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

---

**Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid**

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

---

**Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates**

Which retained record or material explains the work or problem you described?

---

**Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate**

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

---

**Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher**

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

---

**Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks**

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

---

**Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop**

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

---

**Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote**

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

---

**Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme**

What retained paper or record supports your account, and what does it disclose?

---

*Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.*

---



Dada DiCapo

---

### Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.  
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

#### IF INNOCENT

The rehearsal photograph shows an empty jacket on a hinged stand. No drink was used in the effect. The stage manager kept the canceled sequence and my notebook sketch, including the original credit. The red foil-backed scraps in my program came from the closing confetti, cut from the shared materials stock. I intended a fake collapse and a public embarrassment. The retained plan records what that effect actually involved.

#### IF MURDERER

I wrote the warning. The stage manager had my unapproved revision. Grant wanted his foundation's credit restored before the performance. The inventory records a foil-backed red scrap caught in my working program. I carried that through the walkthrough and to Grant's table. I moved his glass to leave the revised program beside it.

*The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.  
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Dada DiCapo

---

## Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

**Your character name**

---

**I accuse**

---

**Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction**

---

---

**Best Actor**

---

**Best Costume**

---



Dada DiCapo

---

## The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

### IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I intended to run the canceled performance. The jacket on the stand was empty, and the rehearsal used no drink. The metallic paper came from our closing effect. I did not poison Grant. I wanted his name taken off my work in front of the donors. I will admit the unauthorized plan and insist that the surviving sketch retain its actual credit.

### IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took cyanide during the preparation walkthrough. While the glass was uncovered, I used it to poison Grant's glass during that visit. A piece of the bottle seal caught in my working program when I opened it. I carried it to the table without noticing; another fragment landed in the glass. The inventory and laboratory comparison exposed that connection. He took my work and credited his foundation. I made the closing reveal a murder.

*Every selected suspect gets their final word.*